

5 Ways to Squeeze Savings from Your Workplace

If you are a cube dweller like me, you may be familiar with the usual benefits of a salary and paid days off, but there are many other ways you can benefit from your workplace. I am not talking about stealing pens or embezzling large sums of money.

These are some of the practical and legal means you can use to squeeze just a little bit of extra savings for yourself.

1. Keep Tupperware or plastic bags in your cube

Not every workplace gives out free food, but if there is an instance when there is a lot of leftover food left in the break room, you should be ready to take some home. In my last company we had monthly lunches for the entire company, and every time there was tons of food left. My manager and I routinely brought home trays of food

that lasted for two to three meals. He would have shopping bags readied for his haul. We only do this when everyone has eaten. My rationale is that the food would be thrown away if I didn't take any.

2. Milk the travel rewards

Do you travel a lot for your employer? If so, make sure to sign up for all the mileage and hotel programs that correspond to your travel. Generally the miles and points you rack up with business travel can be used by you personally.

Some of the people I know who work at consulting firms are able to pick up free hotel stays and flights without paying a dime of their own money. One of my coworkers from out of town told us that he is staying at six different Starwood hotels this week so that he can get platinum status under their rewards program. Once he has platinum status he can use his rewards to get highly discounted hotel rates for himself.

No matter how often you are on the go for work, it is possible to take advantage of the travel rewards.

3. Use the recycled paper

In every office I know of there is a printer room with a recycling bin full